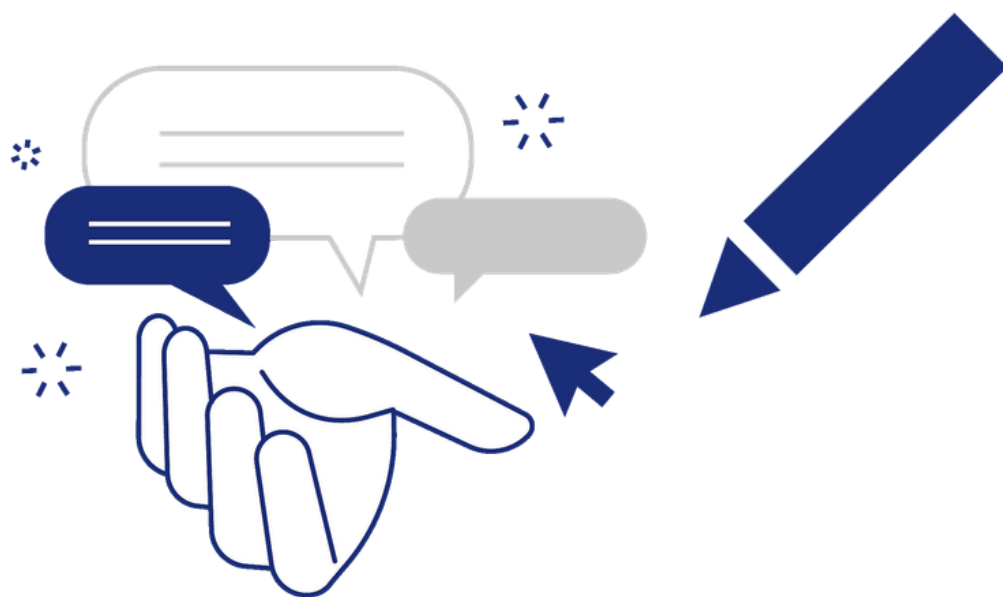


BRIDGE ACROSS ROLES

Learner Worksheets, Activities & Practice Guide

Perspective-Seeking & Collaboration



Name: _____

Date: _____

Visual Checklist



Ask for perspective
before starting



Align viewpoints before
deciding



Understand impact to
other teams



Ask for perspectives
from others

Name: _____

Date: _____

Before you move on - Identify your Misalignment Moment”.

Section 1: The situation

Describe a real project or decision that slowed down because teams weren't aligned.

What happened?

Section 2: Your lens

- What was your role?
- What were you prioritizing at the time?
- What assumptions were you operating under?



Section 3: The disconnect

- Which team felt hardest to align with?
- What might they have been prioritizing differently?

Section 4: The Missed Shift

- What question could you have asked to better understand their view?
- Where did you feel your role wasn't fully understood?
- What did they say or not say?
- How did it affect how you engaged with them or the project?

Hold this example in mind. You'll return to it as we explore how small shifts in language can prevent misalignment?

Name: _____

Date: _____

When Bridging Meets Resistance: What to Do Next

Why This Matters?

Bridging language is powerful, but it doesn't always land the first time. People might:

- Be too busy to engage
- Feel like “input” doesn’t mean influence
- Assume their role isn’t relevant
- Resist because they’ve been burned by misalignment in the past



If someone says no, stays silent, or deflects your effort to collaborate across roles, it doesn't mean the door is closed, it just means you may need to try again differently.

These strategies strengthen emotional intelligence skills like:

- **Self-awareness (managing reactions to rejection or discomfort)**
- **Empathy (understanding why someone may hesitate)**
- **Relationship skills (building trust and shared respect over time)**

Name: _____

Date: _____

Want to Practice? Pair this tool with these practice prompts from the main lesson:

- **Let's align our views before we decide.**
- **What might this look like from your end**
- **Can you see any tensions we should know about?**
- **Try 1 bridging question with someone outside your function this week, even if they've said "no" before.**

Add to Your Learning Journal:

- What happened?
- How did they respond this time?
- How did you feel while asking?



Name: _____

Date: _____



GLOSSARY SORT & MATCH CHALLENGE



Build the Bridge: Language That Shapes Teams

A) QUICK MATCH (CORE TERMS)

Draw an arrow to match each term to its meaning.

TERMS

Cross-functional collaboration
Silo mentality
Bridging phrases
Perspective-seeking
Alignment

MEANINGS

- A. Teams working in isolation without sharing information
- B. Making sure everyone understands and agrees before moving forward
- C. Working together across different roles toward one goal
- D. Respectful questions that connect different roles
- E. Asking how others see a situation

B) SCENARIO SORT (USE THE RIGHT WORD)

Write the correct term in the box.

TERMS

Sidelined, Sense check,
Psychological safety,
Consensual decision-making,
Functional lens,
Stay in your lane

SCENARIOS

- A student feels left out of a group decision.

- A team pauses to confirm everyone is on track.

- People are afraid to speak up during discussions.

- A team listens to everyone before deciding.

- Different roles see the same problem in different ways.

- Someone says "stay in your lane" and the group stops sharing ideas.

Name: _____

Date: _____



SPARK: “Who Got Left Out?”

Story:

The Marketing team shared a launch date. Operations hadn't finished their work. Finance approved the budget but didn't tell anyone. People got frustrated because teams weren't talking to each other.

ACTIVITY 1: SPOT THE PROBLEMS

- ☐ Teams stayed in their own lane
- ☐ Important info was missed
- ☐ Someone felt left out
- ☐ Everyone agreed before deciding
- ☐ Miscommunication slowed progress

***Check mark which problem you think the team is having**



ACTIVITY 2: SEE IT FROM THEIR SIDE

Fill in what each team might be thinking:

Team

Marketing

Operations

Finance

ACTIVITY 3: ONE QUESTION TO FIX IT

Write one question you could ask to get everyone on the same page: _____

(Hint: “What would this look like from your team?” or “How does this affect your work?”)

Name: _____

Date: _____

SHIFT: “Build the Bridge”



ACTIVITY 2: SAY IT YOUR WAY

Pick a phrase:

- ☐ What would this look like from your role?
- ☐ Let's align our views before we decide.
- ☐ How does this impact your team?
- ☐ What's your perspective from where you sit?

Rewrite it so it sounds like you would actually say it: _____

Check your tone:

- ☐ Curious ☐ Respectful ☐ Encourages teamwork

ACTIVITY 1: WHICH PHRASE WORKS?

Circle the phrases that invite teamwork:

“Let's align our views before we decide.”

“Ops needs to handle this, right?”

“What's your perspective from where you sit?”

“We already decided.”

“How does this impact your team?”

How many did you circle? _____

ACTIVITY 3: FIX THE MINI-DIALOGUE

Product Lead: “I think we're aligned to launch Friday.”

Ops Partner: “That's news to me.”

Write a bridging response

below: _____

Why would this help everyone get along better?



**WORKPLACE
EDGE**